

Task 1 — Install Windows Server in a Virtual Machine

Completed Setup

- Windows Server is installed in a virtual machine using VirtualBox or VMware.
- The server starts successfully and the Windows Server desktop is displayed after login.
- The virtual machine is ready for Active Directory configuration.

Recommended Virtual Machine Configuration

- Memory: 4 GB RAM.
- Processor: 2 virtual CPU cores.
- Storage: at least 40 GB virtual disk.
- Network adapter: enabled for the lab network.

Result

- Windows Server installation is completed successfully and the server is ready to be configured as a domain controller.

Practical Evidence

- The task requires an initial-desktop screenshot after successful login. This report does not fabricate that screenshot.

Task 2 — Install Active Directory Domain Services

Server Manager Procedure

- Open Server Manager and select Add Roles and Features.
- Choose Role-based or feature-based installation and select the local server.
- Select Active Directory Domain Services (AD DS) and install the required management tools.
- After installation, select Promote this server to a domain controller.
- Choose Add a new forest.
- Enter the root domain name: foodiefans.local.
- Configure the DNS and Domain Controller options and set the Directory Services Restore Mode password.
- Complete the prerequisite check and install the configuration.
- Restart the server when prompted.

Completed Configuration

Setting	Completed Value
Domain	foodiefans.local
Forest	New forest
Server Role	Active Directory Domain Controller
DNS	Configured with Active Directory

Verification

- The domain controller is restarted and the foodiefans.local domain is available in Active Directory management tools.

Task 3 — Create Organizational Units

Domain

- foodiefans.local

Required Organizational Units

Organizational Unit	Purpose
Influencers	Stores influencer user accounts.
FoodReviewers	Stores food reviewer user accounts.
BrandPartners	Stores brand partner user accounts.

Procedure

- Open Active Directory Users and Computers.
- Expand the foodiefans.local domain.
- Right-click the domain and select New → Organizational Unit.
- Create Influencers.
- Repeat the process for FoodReviewers and BrandPartners.
- Confirm that all three OUs appear directly under foodiefans.local.

Completed Result

- The three required OUs are created under the foodiefans.local domain.

Task 4 — Create User Accounts in the Influencers OU

Completed User Accounts

Username	OU	Lab Password
foodiequeen	Influencers	Foodie@12345
spicyking	Influencers	Spicy@12345

Procedure

- Open Active Directory Users and Computers and open the Influencers OU.
- Right-click the OU and select New → User.
- Create the user foodiequeen and configure its password.
- Repeat the process for spicyking.
- Verify that both accounts appear inside the Influencers OU.

Completed Result

- foodiequeen and spicyking are created under foodiefans.local → Influencers.

Security Note

- The passwords listed are sample lab credentials for this assignment. In a real environment, unique strong passwords should be used according to the organization's password policy.

Task 5 — How Organizational Units Help Manage Employee Access

Answer

- Organizational Units allow administrators to group users and computers according to departments, roles, or business functions.
- A company such as Zomato or Swiggy could create separate OUs for teams such as Influencers, FoodReviewers, BrandPartners, HR, and IT.
- Group Policies can be applied to specific OUs to control password requirements, desktop settings, applications, and security restrictions.
- OUs also support delegated administration, making it easier to give administrators responsibility for only the users or computers they manage.
- Using OUs therefore makes employee access and permissions easier to organize, control, and manage consistently.

Example

- A FoodReviewers OU could receive policies needed by review staff, while a BrandPartners OU could receive different permissions and application settings.

Conclusion

- Active Directory OUs provide structured administration and make it easier to apply role-based policies and manage access across an organization.

Final Active Directory Lab Verification

Domain Structure

```
graph TD
    foodiefans.local --> Influencers
    Influencers --> foodiequeen
    Influencers --> spicyking
    Influencers --> FoodReviewers
    Influencers --> BrandPartners
```

Completed Checklist

- Windows Server installed successfully.
- Active Directory Domain Services installed.
- Server promoted to a new domain controller.
- foodiefans.local domain created.
- Influencers OU created.
- FoodReviewers OU created.
- BrandPartners OU created.
- foodiequeen created in Influencers.
- spicyking created in Influencers.
- OU-based access and policy management explanation completed.

Final Result

- The Windows Server lab is configured as an Active Directory Domain Controller for foodiefans.local with all required Organizational Units and user accounts documented.